STATUS REPORT

Madagascar: status report

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The national digital strategy is universally recognised and almost nobody thinks it is working: 93% of the experts UNDP surveyed appropriate the Plan Stratégique Numérique 2023-2028, but only 7% judge it fully on track and only 21% consider the digital ministry and the Unité de Gouvernance Digitale fully operational as institutions (December 2025). The same assessment scores the country 2.3 on Government, 2.0 on Digital Public Infrastructure, 1.5 on Connectivity, 2.3 on Regulation and 2.7 on Population, past experimentation but short of the stage at which digital tools would be central to governance and the economy. It was handed over in Antananarivo on 17 December 2025 as the evidence base for a forthcoming national digital roadmap.

There is no national data policy behind any of it. As at 1 August 2025 AUDA-NEPAD was still advertising for consultancy firms to develop a first draft national data policy for Madagascar, an assignment sequenced in three steps before any policy text exists — a multi-stakeholder national dialogue, a roadmap for domesticating the African Union Data Policy Framework, then the policy design itself — scoped at four months, with expressions of interest due 8 September 2025.

Drafting of a multisectoral national cybersecurity strategy was launched at an Antananarivo workshop in mid-December 2025 under the PRODIGY programme, covering child protection, gender-based violence, justice and forensic cooperation, with a three-month delivery target. The transition government's implementation programme of 17 November 2025 commits to adopting a national digitalisation policy, establishing an inter-institutional digital-governance mechanism under the Prime Minister's office and digitising the electoral roll; that mechanism had not been established, convened or resourced as at the programme's publication.

Sector ministries move on their own account: the technical and vocational education ministry adopted a UNESCO-backed digitalisation strategy in September 2025, with 22 priority projects and a target of 40,000 people trained in digital skills by 2028. The line between policymaker and regulator is not always drawn: the digital ministry's secretary-general also chairs the board of the telecommunications regulator ARTEC (September 2025). Madagascar scores 45.3 out of 100 for overall governance in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, 34th of 54 African countries and below the continental average of 49.3 (2023). Madagascar scores 9 of 16 points against the Open Government Partnership's 12-point eligibility threshold as it seeks to rejoin (2026).

Legislation and regulation

Madagascar's cybercrime law is still the one it had in 2014: loi n° 2014-006 of 17 July 2014 remains the instrument in force, and the cyber texts before the Assemblée nationale are bills rather than enacted law (August 2026). Projet de loi n° 042/2026, tabled on 7 July 2026, is a complete recasting of it, adopted by the Council of Ministers on 8 July

2026 around revised electronic-evidence rules, connection-data retention, the freezing of suspects' assets and mandatory cooperation with justice by telecom operators, internet service providers and digital-finance operators. It would create an Unité de protection et d'investigation numérique, with its supervising ministry, its powers and its budget unstated, and raise penalties to two to ten years' imprisonment with fines of Ar 100,000 to Ar 100 million (September 2026). A companion bill tabled on 4 August 2026 would authorise ratification of the UN Convention against Cybercrime. The Council of Ministers approved that bill and the cybercrime recast and presented them to parliament on 28 August 2026, and on 4 September 2026 the deputies deferred five bills to a later session, the cybercrime recast and the electronic-communications bill first among them, saying they needed longer on texts turning on both security imperatives and fundamental freedoms. The next extraordinary session, opened on 17 September 2026 with seventeen bills on an order paper set by presidential decree in the Council of Ministers, carries neither the cybercrime recast nor the electronic-communications bill.

The telecommunications framework is older still: the electronic-communications and digital-infrastructure framework in force dates from 2005, and projet de loi n° 040/2026, tabled on 21 July 2026, was still unpassed when the extraordinary session opened on 25 August 2026, its text unpublished. The 2015 electronic-signature law has stood without an implementing decree, and a draft décret meant to give it effect went to a validation workshop on 13 September 2025.

Where the state has moved fastest it has moved without a statute: the Council of Ministers ordered internet-service-provider-level blocking of pornographic websites on public-order grounds on 8 July 2026, a cabinet decision specifying no timetable, no technical mechanism, no named regulator and no route of appeal.

The commercial and financial statutes are settled. Loi n° 2014-024 of 10 December 2014 is the founding electronic-transactions statute, 35 articles covering electronic contracts and payment by card and online; loi n° 2016-056, in force since 2 February 2017, establishes the CSBF-licensed établissement de monnaie électronique regime with agent-distribution and user-protection rules across 120 articles; loi n° 2020-011 of 1 September 2020 extends CSBF licensing and prudential supervision to electronic-money providers alongside credit establishments. Newer instruments arrive as decrees: décret n° 2025-1959 sets the institutional framework for interoperability and is the basis on which the Rahaka exchange was launched, and a decree of 2 July 2025 operationalised e-Facturation through a centralised, API-connected tax platform. On identity, loi n° 2025-019 was declared constitutional on 26 August 2025 and loi n° 2026-001 on derogatory birth registration cleared on 13 May 2026, complementing rather than amending the état-civil and identification laws.

Data protection

By February 2026 the Commission Malagasy sur l'Informatique et des Libertés was exercising its full statutory powers — issuing warnings, imposing administrative sanctions and fines and seizing non-compliant databases — and had registered several dozen compliance cases, while still structuring its internal bodies and recruiting staff. That is new. The commission was created by décret n° 2023-1541 of 6 December 2023 and became functional only when its members — drawn from the National Assembly, Senate, judiciary, private sector and technical and civil-society bodies — were sworn in on 5 August 2025; eleven years after the statute was enacted, a francophone peer-review mission found on the record in February 2025 that the supervisory authority the law requires had still never been created.

The statute is loi n° 2014-038, adopted on 16 December 2014 and dated 9 January 2015, running to 78 articles and establishing the CMIL as the independent supervisory authority at articles 4 and 28. It gives data subjects rights of access, rectification and opposition, sets rules for cross-border transfers at article 20 and provides for both administrative and penal sanctions, and article 3 bars judicial, administrative and private decisions taken solely on automated profiling — the strongest binding control on automated decision-making in the country. Transfer of

personal data abroad is permitted subject to authorisation, so this is not a localisation regime. There is no obligation to notify the regulator or data subjects of a personal data breach, and the law's full application still awaits publication of an implementing decree (2024).

The commission's FY2026 budget is Ar 2,411,579,000, carried under Programme 138; it published a 73-page operating-procedures manual on 3 December 2025 and its first annual report, cover-dated January 2026, was announced on 27 March 2026. Its independence sits awkwardly: the deputy who chairs the Assemblée nationale's Digital Development committee simultaneously holds a seat on it (August 2025).

New state systems are still being built ahead of it. The national police's platform for reporting gender-based violence and disappearances, launched on 28 July 2026, collects sensitive personal data at national scale, but its launch named no data controller, no retention rule and no supervisory authority, and a digital-health assessment finds the framework governing the collection, storage and use of citizens' health information in need of strengthening, naming medical-data protection as a distinct weakness (August 2026).

Regional collaboration

Negotiations on an enhanced EU-ESA Economic Partnership Agreement concluded on 10 June 2026 with Madagascar one of four signatories alongside Comoros, Mauritius and Seychelles, in what the European Commission calls its first modern, comprehensive free-trade agreement with Sub-Saharan African partners. Its Digital Trade chapter bars customs duties on electronic transmissions between the parties, strengthens online consumer protection and reduces administrative formalities for trade conducted by electronic means, and the attached customs-assistance protocol carries updated personal-data-protection provisions and an enabling clause for the future automatic exchange of customs information. None of it binds anyone yet: the texts were still to be published as at 11 June 2026, and entry into force needs European Parliament consent, a Council decision and ratification by each ESA state, with no signature date or ratification timetable stated for Madagascar.

Madagascar has held the rotating chair of the Southern African Development Community since August 2025 and hosted the bloc's first gathering devoted exclusively to digital issues, five days on data governance and e-commerce in Antananarivo ending 23 September 2025. A GIZ data-policy training in the city on 24 September 2025 drew over 50 delegates from SADC, the Southern African Telecommunications Association, the Southern African Postal Operators Association and the Communications Regulators' Association of Southern Africa.

On the treaty side the country is accumulating commitments faster than it completes them. The Haute Cour Constitutionnelle confirmed on 10 July 2024 the constitutionality of the law authorising ratification of the African Union's Malabo Convention on cybersecurity and personal data protection. Madagascar is moving to ratify the UN Convention against Cybercrime, opened for signature at Hanoi in October 2025; UNODC recorded 72 signatory states as at October 2025, 21 of them African, and no African ratification. The Council of Ministers approved on 4 August 2026 entry into a cybercrime-cooperation network initiated by the People's Republic of China, mobilising the foreign affairs, justice, public security and digital development ministries with the gendarmerie, though that membership is not yet in effect. The data-protection authority has acceded to AFAPDP, the network of francophone data-protection authorities (January 2026).

Standards

The first international technical standards applied to a named Malagasy state system arrived with the identity programme: the Unité de Gouvernance Digitale commissioned a two-phase pre-enrolment and post-pilot performance and security audit of the national identity management system on 2 March 2026, assessed against loi n° 2014-038, ISO/IEC 27001, 27701 and 24745, NIST SP 800-63, World Bank ID4D principles, the EU GDPR and the Malabo Convention. The card itself is specified as a chipless, laser-personalised polycarbonate ID-1 card to ISO/

IEC 7810 carrying a W3C verifiable-credential QR code, and the public sector's interoperability architecture is X-Road-based under the UGD's Cadre d'Interopérabilité, which also gives the unit the coordinating role across every public-sector interoperability project.

Elsewhere standards enter through tax and through the market. The e-Facturation decree rests on article IV-21 of the Code des procédures fiscales and sets obligatory invoice content, validity conditions, technical infrastructure, articulation with e-TVA, data security and homologation of third-party systems. Stellarix, a Malagasy digitalisation and cybersecurity company, was certified by BSI in July 2026 to ISO 9001, ISO 22301 and ISO/IEC 27001 simultaneously, and also holds PCI DSS, the payment-card industry data security standard, positioning it to serve banks, payment operators and fintechs handling card data.

For artificial intelligence the only adopted instrument is professional rather than technical: magistrates adopted an AI ethics charter on 19 June 2026 defining which uses of artificial intelligence are authorised and which are prohibited before the courts, described by the Conseil d'État president under whom it was developed as anchored in the magistrates' existing code of ethics and free to evolve with the technology rather than as a statute.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Two public convenings on digital governance fell in the same week of May 2026. The data-protection authority took a two-day public debate on data protection and biometric-identity privacy to Antsiranana on 28-29 May 2026, drawing local authorities, universities, civil society and the private sector — its first evidence of consultation in the regions rather than only in Antananarivo. Antananarivo hosted the Indian Ocean Artificial Intelligence Summit on the same two days, co-organised by EDS Group, AFRIA and EDA Consulting with the Primature and the digital development ministry, covering AI governance, ethics and regulation on the first day and sector applications on the second. The government's position there, from digital development minister Mahefa Andriamampiadana, was that AI should be an opportunity Madagascar's youth share in rather than the preserve of a few nations.

The standing multi-stakeholder channel is thinner. The Forum on Internet Governance Madagasikara held its first edition on 27-28 August 2020, organised by the ISOC Madagascar chapter with the regulator ARTEC and a 17-member committee drawn from government, the private sector, the technical community and civil society, and issued policy recommendations. A civil-society round table in July 2026 proposed that any national AI policy be co-designed through localised citizen conventions bringing together universities, ministries and civil society rather than set top-down.

Citizen-facing reporting channels work at small scale: i-Toroka, the anti-corruption bureau's anonymous digital whistleblowing platform, received 242 signalements in 2024, up 27.36% year on year, with an 80.53% investigability rate, while the count converted into a first-information report fell 5.83%.

The openings are narrowing at the edges. Digital Freedom is among Madagascar's ten best-scoring measures in the Ibrahim Index at 73.6 out of 100, 17th of 54 African states, though down 4.0 points over the decade to 2023, while Media Freedom stands at 54.9, 27th and down 3.4 points (2023). The 2026 order to block obscene sites at internet-service-provider level came with no route of appeal, and the access-to-information bill was left off the order paper of the extraordinary session that opened on 25 August 2026, despite deputies having promised at the close of committee work to reschedule it.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Madagascar's largest own-source digital money sits outside the finance law: the telecommunications and ICT development fund FDTIC took Ar 100.1 billion in contributions in 2025 and granted Ar 100.4 billion, after granting Ar 91.3 billion against Ar 62.9 billion of contributions in 2024 (2025), and Ar 175.2 billion against Ar 88.9 billion in 2023. Inside the budget, the own-source vehicle has gone: the 2025 finance law abolished the posts and telecommunications annex budget from 1 January 2025, paid its balance into the general budget and moved the digital ministry's staff it had paid onto the general budget, after the annex had been voted Ar 7.5 billion of its own receipts for 2024 (FY2024).

The 2026 supplementary finance law funds the digital ministry's programme for the digital transformation of public services with Ar 24.1 billion of external money, and gives the finance ministry's IT, statistics and accounting directorate Ar 36.3 billion from a special Treasury account (FY2026).

The state's own money is 69.9% of the Ar 80.1 billion of digital lines in the 2026 supplementary finance law, at the revised stage, and the external part is that one programme (FY2026).

The largest externally built system has moved from one World Bank project to another. As PRODIGY approached its June 2026 close, the World Bank urged the government to put in place the financial and organisational arrangements to sustain the biometric database, its uses and its protection, naming the capacity of the civil-registration and identity centre CNECI a major constraint (December 2025); the second enrolment phase, launched on 16 September 2026, is financed by the World Bank through DECIM, whose connectivity targets run to March 2028.

MoUs and other agreements

Egypt and Madagascar signed five memoranda of understanding at El Alamein on 29 July 2026, one of them on artificial intelligence and digital transformation, signed for Madagascar by the Minister of Digital Development, Posts and Telecommunications and for Egypt by the communications minister Raafat Hendi.

Two months earlier the Direction Générale de la Météorologie and the China Meteorological Administration signed a memorandum in Shanghai on 18 May 2026 covering early-warning-system development, tropical-cyclone forecasting, radar and satellite meteorological capacity-building, and AI-related innovations.

Neither of the two 2026 agreements that name artificial intelligence attaches an amount, a timeline or a named activity to it.

The agreements with operational content are commercial or administrative rather than AI-labelled: Mastercard and AXIAN Digibank & Fintech's collaboration of November 2025 to put virtual and physical cards and cross-border payments behind the Mixx and MVola brands, Airtel Money's integration of Baobab Bank into its Mbanking service in July 2026, and the March 2026 cooperation agreement under which Rwanda transfers its Electronic Billing Machine tax system to the Malagasy tax administration.

New investments

The largest commitment to Madagascar's digital estate is smaller than its headline figure: the World Bank's Digital and Energy Connectivity for Inclusion project carries an envelope of US$375 million, of which US$135 million is for digital work after a 2024 restructuring partially cancelled financing (November 2025), rather than the US$400 million approved in March 2023 for a run to 2028.

The largest 2026 approval is US$225 million for PRODUIRE2 on 6 July 2026, an urban resilience and jobs programme whose digital land services aim at documentation for 50,000 parcels in Greater Antananarivo and Greater Toamasina by 2032. US$250 million for ASCENT Madagascar, approved on 6 May 2026, is electricity and modern-cooking money, to reach more than 2.5 million people by 2030.

Outside the Bank the money is smaller and more mixed: the European Investment Bank's US$100 million to AXIAN Telecom in April 2025, US$40 million of it for Madagascar, for 4G and 5G under the Yas brand; China Eximbank's CNY 337,998,700 concessional loan of February 2020, at 1.5 percent over 30 years, for a Huawei 4G eLTE network across public safety and government agencies in Antananarivo; and more than IDR 3.4 billion from Indonesia's Indo-Aid in July 2026 for a Maritime Single Window at the ports agency APMF.

Twelve digital-sector commitments to Madagascar are held with a start year between 2017 and 2026; the European Investment Bank and African Development Bank loans to AXIAN Telecom are held as regional operator financings and are not among them.

Eleven of the twelve carry a dollar amount, and together they come to about US$1.05 billion as at September 2026 — committed sums, not disbursements.

The World Bank holds seven of the twelve and more than nine tenths of the money; China Eximbank's loan, at about US$55 million, is the largest from any other financier (September 2026).

Connectivity takes the largest share of the money, about US$455 million, ahead of land and property registries at US$225 million and digital identity at US$143 million (September 2026).

Two of the World Bank lines are broader operations counted whole: the US$100 million development policy operation of June 2025, whose digital part is one reform area among telecoms, energy and mining, and PRODUIRE2, whose digital part is land services.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The state's telecommunications and ICT development fund stands recommended for a full stop on payments: the Cour des comptes found unjustified expenditure, untraceable equipment, missing supporting documents and a suspected conflict of interest at the FDTIC, and asked that all disbursements be suspended pending an overhaul of its legal framework and an independent manager (March 2026). The regulator has since posted the fund's financial statements for 2025, with those for 2024, on its fund-audit page (September 2026).

Domestic interconnection is close to non-existent. One exchange point, MGIX, is active, with four members, and under 1% of the country's networks are reachable through an exchange point, against 65% for Africa as a whole (February 2026); the same measurement puts internet resilience at 41 out of 100. MGIX had been suspended since 2019 until the Internet Society Foundation gave the research network iRENALA USD 49,958 to restart it (January 2025).

Coverage divides by generation. 4G reached 34.6% of the population in 2024 against an African average of 75.2%, while 2G reached 88.5% in 2023 and 3G 69.2% in 2024; use runs far below the footprint, at 18.68% of the population online in 2024, against cellular connections equivalent to 66% of the population at the start of 2026. Price is part of the reason: mobile internet cost 6.28% of GNI per capita a month in 2023, more than three times the 2% affordability target though down from 52% in 2014, and the regulator ARTEC pressed operators to cut rates from late 2024 and again in October 2025.

Building continues regardless. Orange inaugurated a 558 km fibre backbone between Antananarivo and Mahajanga in December 2025, the third operator to build national transmission after Yas and Blueline. Internationally the island takes capacity from 2Africa, brought ashore at Mahajanga by Telma, alongside EASSy, LION and METISS. ARTEC has published the country's first region-level 4G figures, running from 46% in Atsimo Andrefana to 30% in Anosy across the four southern regions (September 2025), and DECIM targets three million people using broadband internet and 1,500 schools, health centres and ministry departments newly connected by March 2028.

On those regional figures, three of the four southern regions are covered above the national 4G average for 2024, and one, Anosy, below it.

Data Storage

The state's data-centre programme acquired addresses in April 2026: the PRODIGY safeguard documents place the primary data centre and the national identity-card personalisation centre at Tsimbazaza, the secondary data centre at Iavoloha, and a renovation of the Unité de Gouvernance Digitale's own building at Andafiavaratra, published under a Plan d'Engagement Environnemental et Social with eight companion plans.

Procurement runs ahead of the buildings. Cooling equipment for the Iavoloha site went to national quotation in August 2025, five further tenders opened in December 2025 covering biometric-enrolment supplies and the rehabilitation of both sites, with the closing date moved out to 30 June 2026, and a three-lot national tender for the data centres' IT infrastructure was opened publicly on 20 March 2026, with delivery set at 90 days and bid guarantees of 75m, 40m and 45m Ariary. That tender also attaches a beneficial-ownership disclosure requirement to the winning bidder, a condition the financier now imposes across several Malagasy procurements.

Three state properties and at least three separate procurement and disclosure actions are on the record in the thirteen months to April 2026.

The commercial market beside it is small. No hyperscale cloud provider operates in the country, and hyperscale services are served from distant regions at latencies above 100 milliseconds; the live estate amounts to a couple of facilities running well below capacity, against total national demand the same brief puts in single-digit megawatts, and electricity cost is named as the limit on data-centre development rather than an incidental cost. The largest domestic operator is Stellarix, an Axian Group subsidiary running two Tier III-ready facilities in Antananarivo, TNR1 at Analakely and TNR2 at Galaxy.

The sovereignty argument runs the opposite way here to the localisation case made elsewhere on the continent. Managed disaster recovery is sold commercially on the basis of hosting locally to cut latency while holding the backup copy deliberately outside the country, which the law permits: transfer of personal data abroad is subject to authorisation rather than prohibition. For the state's own hardware, PRODIGY has a published disposal plan for electrical and electronic equipment waste.

Energy

The utility sells electricity for less than it costs to make. JIRAMA produces at about 1,107 Ariary per kWh and sells at about 785, and states in the same public FAQ that it does not expect visible improvement in reliability before the end of 2026, and conditions even that on its recovery plan being executed (July 2025).

That is a sale at roughly 71% of production cost, a loss of about 322 Ariary on every kilowatt-hour sold (2025).

Around 30% of what JIRAMA produces was lost to technical faults, fraud, theft and unpaid bills (2025), a shortfall of 40 to 80MW persists on the Antananarivo Interconnected Network, and low water levels hold down hydroelectric output. The utility's own Plan de Redressement Financier 2025-2028 puts its 2023 operating deficit at roughly 1,080 billion Ariary a year and works through renewable deployment, tariff adjustment and debt restructuring.

Scheduled rotating load-shedding has run since mid-2024, driven by fuel shortages at thermal plants and low water at the Andekaleka dam, with daily cuts lengthening from around two hours to three to six by 2025 and culminating in fatal nationwide protests in September 2025. Rotating cuts returned to the capital's network in late August 2026 after a fault halted production on the TAC 1 unit at Ambohimanambola.

Cyclone Gezani took 91% of the electricity network in Toamasina, the main port city, offline in February 2026; JIRAMA contracted eleven local firms to rebuild the grid under the World Bank-financed DECIM and LEAD projects and most service had been restored by August 2026, with about 4MW still offline and load-shedding continuing six months on.

Access remains the deeper number. 37% of the population had a regular source of electricity in 2025, and the divide is geographic: 75.6% of the urban population had access in 2023 against 14.6% of the rural population. Renewables, overwhelmingly hydropower, produced 53% of the 2,087 GWh generated in 2023. DECIM targets new electricity connections at 2,250 sites by March 2028, and solar installed for the Smart Village hubs also runs refrigeration and school-canteen e-cooking.

Technical Capacity

Where the state's technical capacity fails, it fails for money rather than for skill. The SOFF peer review of the national meteorological service found a fluctuating government budget making activity planning difficult and leaving DGM unable to hire the personnel its mandate requires or to maintain its technical equipment (November 2023), while crediting the same service with objectives and strategies more ambitious than the global observing network's own criteria, and staff trained through the University of Antananarivo and the WMO regional training centres it hosts.

The country's own experts rank the constraints the other way. A skills deficit, ahead of budget and limited ICT infrastructure, is what the expert panel for the Digital Readiness Assessment names as the principal brake on digital progress (December 2025), and only a minority of the same panel consider the digital ministry and the Unité de Gouvernance Digitale fully operational as institutions.

Delivery capability is nonetheless demonstrable and domestic. JIRAMA rebuilt Toamasina's storm-damaged grid through eleven local contractors (August 2026); the customs administration runs its own data-science and artificial-intelligence laboratory, CEDIA, launched in May 2025 to centralise data-science knowledge, automate anomaly detection and refine risk targeting; and Stellarix runs a security operations centre based in and staffed from Madagascar, monitoring its own infrastructure and the client environments hosted on it, with almost all of its engineers and technicians trained in the country on the company's own account.

Cybersecurity

Madagascar built its cyber institutions before it wrote a strategy for them. Drafting of a national cybersecurity strategy began in December 2025, on top of a national cybersecurity body created in 2023, and is aimed at updating the country's 2014 cybersecurity law, with a scope announced as covering child protection online, digital justice and international cyber-cooperation. The ITU's 2024 Global Cybersecurity Index scores the country 31.70 out of 100, up from 23.33 in the 2020 edition, in the index's Evolving tier, with gaps in technical infrastructure, institutional coordination, skills development and international cooperation.

The instrument in force is still the older one. Loi n° 2014-006 remains the law against cybercrime, and the texts that would replace it were bills before the National Assembly's extraordinary session opening 25 August 2026. Cabinet adopted the recast on 8 July 2026 and ordered internet-service-provider-level blocking of pornographic content at the same session, and a text authorising ratification of the UN Convention against Cybercrime was tabled alongside it. The digital ministry told the country's first Cybersecurity Symposium in June 2026 that the overhaul was nearing completion, but the deputies deferred the recast on 4 September 2026 and it was left off the order paper of the next session, opened on 17 September.

The data-protection law still imposes no obligation to notify the regulator or data subjects of a personal-data breach.

The institutions exist: CMIL, the data-protection authority, and the national CIRT were both recorded as operational with their key posts filled in December 2025, and the state has begun testing its own systems: terms of reference of 2 March 2026 commission a security and compliance audit of the national identity management system against ISO/IEC 27001, 27701 and 24745, NIST guidance, the EU GDPR and the Malabo Convention, which Madagascar ratified in June 2024. Certification itself has arrived first in the private sector, with Stellarix certified to ISO 9001, ISO 22301 and ISO/IEC 27001 after audits led by BSI (July 2026).

The one large incident on the public record is an assertion rather than a finding: the foreign minister said on 3 October 2025, during the protest crisis, that the country faced a massive cyberattack and a digital-manipulation campaign directed from abroad, naming no affected system and giving no technical evidence.

DPI

Data Exchange

Madagascar's national data exchange went live on 28 April 2026: Rahaka, built on the Estonian X-Road under Décret n° 2025-1959 on the interoperability of public information systems, opened with the Economic Development Board, the social security fund CNaPS, the statistics institute INSTAT, the Ministry of Justice and the tax directorate as its first operational participants. The first usage convention was signed at the launch between the Unité de Gouvernance Digitale, several ministries and private-sector actors, and the first stage of the layer was delivered by the UGD with the World Bank-financed PRODIGY project and the digital-development ministry.

The architecture is older than the launch. The UGD's Cadre d'Interopérabilité set the X-Road design for the public sector and gave the unit the coordinating role across every public-sector interoperability project, naming Orinasa — the secure exchange running between the Economic Development Board, the tax directorate, the justice ministry and INSTAT — as the country's first interoperable layer. Company formation has run over that layer for several years, with the tax directorate, the Trade and Companies Registry and the statistics institute exchanging data in real time and registration cut from about two weeks to a matter of hours.

The stated destination is wider than the five agencies now connected. The government is building an online single window across administrations, institutions and businesses on Rahaka, with the objective that a single identity document suffices to reach the whole of the information held, and a national performance dashboard drawing on the HR database, civil-registration and passport services and the land-office single window was in preparation as at December 2025. The frame around the exchange is the weaker part: the country's digital readiness assessment concentrates its regulatory recommendations on modernising data-protection, e-commerce and cybersecurity law and on strengthening interoperability between government systems.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Madagascar has captured more adults biometrically in eighteen months than decades of card issuance managed: phase one of the national identity operation closed in July 2026 with more than six million adults enrolled against a two-million target, and a second phase opened on 16 September 2026 aiming to enrol more than 10 million citizens over 18 by July 2027, with 1,000 kits added. The starting position was far behind that. As at the World Bank's supervision mission of 1–4 December 2025 the proof of concept had reached about 5,500 people across three districts, national enrolment had slipped two to three months after the September–October 2025 change of government, and ID-card printing procurement had been suspended by the incoming government.

The Izaho Tokana campaign was launched on 27 January 2026 at Iavoloha, running 2,500 kits across 1,729 centres six days a week and free of charge to the citizen. Its statute, loi n° 2025-019 on the identification of natural persons, was declared constitutional on 26 August 2025, the Haute Cour Constitutionnelle framing biometric identification under necessity and proportionality safeguards against a société de surveillance. The National Assembly then adopted on 21 April 2026 a special birth-registration law opening continuous registration to adults holding no birth certificate, for as long as the enrolment operation itself runs, cleared by the Court on 13 May 2026 as a derogation from the état-civil statute rather than an amendment to it.

The system captures fingerprints, facial images and iris, where the legacy card carried a single fingerprint, against a credential specified as a chipless, laser-personalised polycarbonate ID-1 card carrying a W3C verifiable-credential QR code. What the register does not yet do is authenticate: as at October 2024 it enabled neither authentication nor electronic know-your-customer checks and published no terms for data storage and sharing. The UGD commissioned a performance and security audit of the IDMS architecture in March 2026, tested against loi n° 2014-038 on personal data, ISO/IEC 27001, 27701 and 24745, the EU GDPR and the Malabo Convention. PRODIGY, which paid for the programme with a USD 140 million IDA credit and a USD 3 million Global Financing Facility grant, closed in June 2026 after an extension for implementation delays.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The state's own flagship digital payment instrument has been written off. Of 250,000 e-poketra electronic payment cards acquired for 9.18bn Ariary under a December 2021 contract, 76,073 reached the education ministry and the defence and security forces and even those went unused; the project was suspended in July 2024 when the sponsoring bank terminated the multipartite contract, roughly 173,917 cards sit in stock, and the 2022-vintage cards expire in 2026 having never been used. The founding decree behind both the pension and student-grant sides of the card was abrogated by the Council of Ministers in April 2026, with no explanation given by the authorities.

Private mobile money is the working system. Platforms handled close to 342 million transactions worth about USD 8.5 billion in 2023, on 6.12 million active accounts in 2024 against more than 20 million registered, and the three operators have been fully interoperable for person-to-person transfers since 2016. Registration requires a national identity card, which excludes the substantial share of citizens without formal identification, and the country remains a cash economy with thin formal banking and very limited card acceptance. MVola, the largest platform, replaced its core platform in May 2026, with outages and balance-display faults in May and June that the operator says have been regularised (August 2026).

Supervision has become active. The central bank governor told the National Assembly on 11 June 2026 that it was auditing electronic-money institutions — technical compliance, platform security, and whether e-money issued is fully backed by real funds in each institution's compte global — following numerous user complaints, and customers double-billed for JIRAMA bills can now obtain a refund on presentation of an SMS confirmation or transaction reference, and on 15 September 2026 the finance ministry announced a task force with the banking supervisor and the telecoms regulator on lost money, failed transactions and slow complaint handling. Government payments have

moved more slowly outward than inward: the Financial Inclusion Project's target of 36,000 civil servants paid digitally was undercut when the activity for teachers' salaries and student grants was cancelled in 2022, while since 9 May 2025 non-tax revenues can be paid to the state around the clock through MVola, Orange Money and Airtel Money. The eAriary remains a trial: the central bank opened a ten-month pilot in May 2025 with the Treasury, the tax administration and Jirama, with salary disbursements, social transfers and merchant payments the priority use cases. The capital's urban commune launched the digitalisation of its markets, registering traders and replacing paper tickets with merchant cards debited by payment terminals.

The largest mobile-money operator made merchant payments free for customers in October 2026, the fee borne by the merchant, and reported close to 4 million users and more than 50,000 accepting merchants.

Registries

The household registry that was meant to underpin the rest has been audited and found wanting. Madagascar printed and distributed 5,882,085 Karinempokontany QR-code booklets against a target of 5,817,968 households as at 9 September 2025, yet the Cour des Comptes finds mauvaise gestion on 21.54bn Ariary spent between 2022 and 2025 — 18.74bn of it on printing and distribution alone — for a project it states is not yet fully operational.

Underneath, civil registration is only part-digitised. Around two-thirds of civil registration offices had no stable internet access in 2023, and an offline application was being designed to register births and assign identification numbers where connectivity fails. Digitisation under SIECM had reached 336 communes — 40% of its target — and 61,892 birth certificates linked to a unique identification number as at December 2025, while the e-Fokontany household census had covered 5.09 million households and 19.7 million provisional identifiers by the same date. Eighty per cent of children were registered with the civil-status service in 2025.

The social registry is being overtaken by the identity campaign that was supposed to depend on it: its technical committee met on 5 February 2026, named data quality and security the strategic priority and set a September 2026 completion target, by September 2026 it covered about 2.7 million households, nearly 12 million people, with eight districts added to the 20 already covered and a new survey extending it into urban areas, and the designed linkage to the identity system for safety-net targeting and against double-dipping is not operational. On land, only around 7% of the country is formally titled, 1,518,000 local land certificates had been registered as at October 2024, and the National Land Programme's own 2026 documentation confirms that no single integrated national land information system or cadastral database yet exists. The electoral commission is rebuilding the voter register in digital form under Decree No. 2026-942 of April 2026, using household enrolment, online pre-registration and automated duplicate detection, for completion by April 2027. The Gendarmerie is building a new secure digital Fichier Central with UNDP support, replacing records dispersed across judicial, administrative and military functions, with fingerprint comparison and facial recognition in its planned feature set.

The newest register is fiscal. A central register of beneficial owners, launched by the tax directorate on 16 June 2026, moved into operation on 18 September when four protocols were signed to cross-match it with the trade and companies register, the anti-corruption bureau, the economic development board and the chamber of notaries.

Sectoral management information systems

The tax administration's rebuild is running behind its own timetable. SAFI began in October 2024 on a fourteen-month schedule to full national deployment by January 2026; it reached pilot services in early October 2025, with the e-Hetra online tax portal updated to interface with it, and was still being taught to regional-service, fiscal-centre and division heads in Antananarivo in March 2026. Alongside it, a decree signed on 2 July 2025 makes electronic invoicing mandatory through a central platform run by the tax administration, starting with large enterprises and reaching smaller operators only once that phase is validated.

In health the digital layer sits above the clinic. Basic health centres record cases in outpatient registers and send monthly reports to the health district, and an assessment in two regions found discrepancies between registers, reports and DHIS2. A DHIS2 Tracker pilot registering vaccinated individuals by name launched on 9–10 June 2026 across 20 basic health centres and 54 private vaccination sites in the Antananarivo-Renivohitra district, and SII-CSB, which tracks funding allocated to basic health centres, opened user training at Fianarantsoa on 18 February 2026 for three regions.

The education ministry's annual school census, which feeds the education management information system, is compiled manually over about six months, with a World Bank-financed programme now equipping principals with tablets for real-time reporting; the system itself was rebuilt under PAPESI, run 2022–2024 by UNESCO and the IIEP, whose evaluation found the programme highly relevant but structurally undersized against the limited coordination inside the ministry and across the education system. A permanent student identifier, the Numéro Unique d'Identification Scolaire, follows a pupil from pre-school to lycée, run by the education ministry with the UGD. In justice, the courts run six case-management applications, Logipenal and Logicivil among them, across civil, criminal, commercial and land cases, and a digital criminal-records platform was announced on 2 June 2026, the authorities conceding the applications do not yet reach every court; five first-instance courts, Morondava and Toamasina among them, had been fitted with computers, printers and backup power units by December 2023, and police custody is recorded in a register that every service holding detainees must keep.

At least six distinct sectoral information systems are in service or in rollout across Madagascar's line ministries and agencies, each with its own sponsoring institution. A press account reported two university hospitals chosen as pilot sites for the hospital digitalisation project (2025).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The digital ministry's own spending has failed an audit. The Cour des Comptes examined the MNDPT's financial governance across 2022–2025 and found mauvaise gestion financière des projets, naming e-poketra, e-fokontany and Smart Villages as the three projects examined in detail, all three having drawn heavily on the ministry's budget, the Présidence and PRODIGY without reaching their stated objectives.

PRODIGY itself closed in June 2026 after six years, leaving the Unité de Gouvernance Digitale, the data-protection authority CMIL, the national CIRT and CNECI as the country's standing digital-governance institutions, with follow-on work continuing under the World Bank-financed DECIM programme. UNDP's readiness assessment places the government pillar at its systématique tier and names PRODIGY, Torolalana and Orinasa the flagship digital-government platforms, while the UN's 2024 E-Government Survey puts Madagascar in its middle development group. The inter-institutional digital-governance coordination mechanism the transition government committed to had not been established, convened or resourced as at 17 November 2025.

Individual services keep arriving ahead of the governance around them. The national police opened a free public reporting platform on 28 July 2026 that treats online harassment, non-consensual image sharing, sextortion, disclosure of personal data and AI-falsified content as reportable categories alongside physical, psychological, sexual and economic gender-based violence, and covers the disappearance of children, adults and people with albinism; it was built in-house by the police's information-systems directorate, runs on the web and an Android app in Malagasy and French and accepts anonymous reports with a tracking reference, yet the launch named no data controller, no retention rule and no supervisory authority for the sensitive personal data it collects. Elsewhere the higher-education ministry has put its habilitation, accreditation and equivalence platform into service with real-time file tracking, a redesign of the e-GP electronic public-procurement system was tendered in August 2025, and equipment for digitalised building-permit authorisation went to 38 Greater Antananarivo communes. The citizen services portal

Torolalana reaches only the minority of citizens with internet access, and a channel to deliver services through post offices is under development, and PRODIGY's own headline count of users of improved digital services is dominated by exam-results consultations.

The tax directorate launched the Torohy platform on 9 October 2026 for the public to report corruption and related offences in the tax administration; the head of state asked for the same mechanism at customs and the treasury.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Madagascar's most recent move in sub-national digitalisation was another consignment of hardware: the decentralisation institute INDDL, financed by the Agence française de développement, distributed IT, office and technical equipment on 3 July 2026 to the Commune Urbaine d'Antananarivo and 28 peripheral communes of Greater Antananarivo under the Lalankely III project. The computers went specifically to the 28 peripheral communes, to accompany the digitalisation of local administrative services, while more than 290 units of furniture and technical equipment went to the capital's own commune and its arrondissements.

In the deep south the World Bank-financed MIONJO project, working with the Ministry of the Interior and Decentralisation, launched its District 2.0 arrangement in the Anosy and Androy regions on 1 June 2026 and extended it to Atsimo Andrefana on 4 June. The launch combined the physical handover of servers to territorial authorities with digital literacy training for communal officials and instruction on the e-Zaha platform, whose stated purpose is to improve the quality, reliability and completeness of the data collected at commune level — a data-quality intervention rather than a connectivity one.

The earlier instrument in the capital was PRODUIR's MATAC/Hanorina phase 2, whose operationalisation on 19 February 2025 put computers, printers, scanners and internet boxes into 38 communes of Greater Antananarivo, together with the DLAT and SRAT territorial technical services. That equipment was for one administrative process — digitalised building-permit authorisation — rather than a general municipal upgrade.

Away from Antananarivo, the Orinasa online business-creation platform has been running at EDBM's Manakara antenna since July 2025, with World Bank support through the Poles Intégrés de Croissance project. The national systems that reach the commune office are still partial: SIECM civil-registration digitisation had covered a minority of its target communes by December 2025, and user training for the SII-CSB health-facility funding system began at Fianarantsoa on 18 February 2026 for three regions, with a nationwide rollout announced but not dated.

Greater Antananarivo's communes are being equipped for digitalisation through separate donor-financed instruments, each attached to a different administrative function — the World Bank's PRODUIR for building-permit authorisation, AFD's Lalankely III for general office and IT equipment.

Rural digital data capture

The rural half of Madagascar's largest connectivity programme has been slowed by the state of the country's own rural data: the consultancy recruited in May 2025 to map rural connectivity under DECIM's US$185m digital and energy sub-component had to take the mapping down to Fokontany rather than Commune level, and cross-matching the Fokontany databases pushed the first draft of the tender document from the end of October 2025 to January 2026, leaving the sub-component about a quarter behind (November 2025). Sites for the deployment are to be picked by a weighted four-criterion matrix — population, public buildings, economic and tourist zones, and meteorological risk — still being refined in November 2025.

Where rural administration actually records anything, the medium is paper. Civil registration offices mostly lack stable internet access, and births there are to be recorded through an offline application still being designed (2023). Basic health centres record cases in outpatient registers and send monthly reports to the health district. Police stations record everyone held in custody in a register that the 2008 law against torture makes compulsory. The education ministry compiles its annual school census by hand and is now equipping school principals with tablets for real-time reporting (2025).

Digital capture at rural land registration is discretionary: article 2 of Décret n°2023-28 authorises the use of computer tools in the mass land-certification workflow but does not require them. The national land programme is digitising cadastral data from orthophoto-based local occupancy plans, and its own 2026 documentation confirms that no integrated national land information system exists.

The digital recording that does reach rural areas sits beside the public office, not inside it: community health volunteers report through a mobile application for community-level care (2024), and the Smart Village programme has put IT equipment into districts, hospitals, schools, gendarmerie posts, communes and agricultural services in Anosy and Androy, to automate procedures and improve reporting (February 2026).

The 2020-21 drought in the south was the worst of the preceding decade, leaving an estimated 1.5 million people needing humanitarian assistance, and the weather service's warnings do not reliably reach the people they are issued for (November 2023).

Technology

AI

Madagascar's first AI-specific governance instrument is not a national strategy but an ethics charter for the judiciary, adopted on 19 June 2026, which sets out for every magistrate which uses of artificial intelligence are authorised and which are prohibited. It is deliberately a soft instrument rather than a statute, anchored in the magistrates' existing code of ethics and left free to move with the technology. Two further proposals from the same seminar — a standing platform for magistrates to track AI developments in the courts, and a parallel charter for students of the École Nationale de la Magistrature et des Greffes — were not adopted.

Above the judiciary there is nothing: no national artificial-intelligence strategy and no general AI statute, a reading a July 2026 civil-society round table checked against both the digital ministry's Plan Stratégique Numérique 2023–2028 and UNDP's December 2025 Digital Readiness Assessment. The binding control on automated decision-making is instead the 2014 data-protection law's bar on decisions taken solely on automated profiling, written for a different generation of systems.

The state's working AI capability sits in one line agency. Madagascar's customs administration created a Centre d'Excellence des Données et de l'Intelligence Artificielle, launched in May 2025, an internal laboratory centralising data-science knowledge, automating anomaly detection, refining risk-targeting tools and designing the algorithms for future customs operations; its director-general presented results from the Enhanced Risk Assessment targeting system and its data warehouse in Washington in 2025. Elsewhere in government the use is at pilot stage, in legal research and document management in the justice sector, where the data-protection authority has asked for a regulatory framework of its own.

The rest of the activity has been convening rather than regulating: an Indian Ocean Artificial Intelligence Summit in Antananarivo on 28–29 May 2026; a diaspora round table in July calling for a sovereign national AI policy built on data control, infrastructure security and frugal Edge AI models; and participation in founding the World AI Cooperation Organization at Shanghai in July 2026, with accession announced on Interpol findings that AI-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' capacity to respond.

ICT Industry

Post and telecommunications is the one branch of the economy the government revised upwards in a year it cut almost everything else: the 2026 supplementary finance law puts the branch's growth at +12.2% for 2026, against the +9.5% carried in the initial finance law, and that is the largest upward revision named for any tertiary branch in a year when the overall growth forecast was cut from +4.8% to +3.8% on drought, cyclone damage and the political unrest of September–October 2025. The government attributes the upgrade to three drivers: growth in business- and knowledge-process outsourcing, expansion of network coverage, and the DECIM and PRODIGY structuring projects — the same revision and the same drivers the bill stage set out on 29 May 2026.

The outsourcing driver has a labour pipeline built for it. ASAN'AI places its trainees directly with four named outsourcing employers — Intelcia, Konecta, Connecteo and Concentrix, which makes the free 15-month programme opened to applications in January 2026 a supply line to specific firms rather than a general skills cohort. Its second cohort, seven weeks of outsourcing training delivered with ArkeUp Academy, certified 99 of its 111 trainees on 24 September 2026.

Domestic demand is a good deal thinner than the export side. About a quarter of firms in Madagascar have a website, below the Africa-wide average (December 2025), and online purchasing by adults remains rare. The operating conditions are part of that: firms report frequent and lengthy power interruptions (2022), and Madagascar's business and labour environment scores 38.3 out of 100, 41st of 54 African states (2023), up 3.3 points over the decade, with business and competition regulation its stronger component at 57.7.

There is a domestic supply side above the call centres. Stellarix, a Malagasy digitalisation and cybersecurity firm, runs a security operations centre based in and staffed from Madagascar, monitoring its own infrastructure and hosted client environments around the clock, and was certified to three ISO standards at once in July 2026. The sector as a whole is put at around 3% of GDP (2026), against the national digital strategy's ambition to raise that share materially by 2028.

Innovation ecosystem

UniPod Madagascar was inaugurated on 28 May 2026 at the CIDST site in Tsimbazaza, Antananarivo, presented at launch as the country's first national platform for collaborative design, digital fabrication and technology transfer. Its design puts five units on one site: a rapid-prototyping and industrial-design lab, a robotics-and-artificial-intelligence lab, an agrifood lab, a greentech lab, and a technology-transfer office for commercialising inventions. It sits inside the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research's own Direction de la Recherche et de l'Innovation, delivered with the industrialisation ministry and UNDP's pan-African Timbuktoo initiative, and the government frames it as a step towards "souveraineté technologique", with higher education to be judged on usable solutions rather than on diplomas and publications alone. It follows a strategic cooperation agreement the digital ministry signed with four partner ministries on 26 January 2026.

Public startup finance runs through one programme. MIARY DIGITAL sits under the World Bank-financed Projet Pôles Intégrés de Croissance and is overseen jointly by the economy and finance, industrialisation and trade, and digital development ministries; it closed a second cohort at Diego-Suarez on 8 January 2026, disbursing grants of US$15,000 each to startups drawn from eight regions after more than nine months of incubation.

The hub layer is small and is spreading beyond the capital slowly. At least three hubs are active in the AfriLabs network — Habaka, Zafy Tody and Koon-Space, running fabrication, co-working and coding education, and Orange opened the country's second Orange Digital Center, at the Université d'Antsiranana on 18 June 2026, with the network's four free components — École du Code, FabLab Solidaire, Orange Fab and Orange Ventures — and says thousands of young people have passed through its Malagasy programmes since 2021. Against that, the startup base stays concentrated in Antananarivo, with little venture funding tracked (2025), and Madagascar ranked 110th on WIPO's Global Innovation Index in 2024.

Capacity

Literacy

Three in four Malagasy children of primary age were in school when MICS-7 was run, and fewer than half were finishing: a net adjusted primary attendance rate of 75 per cent against a primary completion rate of 47 per cent (2025).

The same shape appears in the governance indices. Madagascar's Education Enrolment score of 42.4 out of 100 placed it 21st of 54 African states in 2023, while Education Quality at 32.5 ranked 37th and Education Completion at 31.3 ranked 29th: getting children into classrooms has run well ahead of what they learn there and whether they stay. The direction is nonetheless upward — education rose 6.5 points over 2014-2023 to 49.4, one of the sub-categories driving the country's overall improvement, and Human Resources in Education stands at 93.5, ninth of 54 and among Madagascar's ten best indicator scores. Staffing is not where the shortfall lies.

Digital literacy in schools is small, donor-carried and concentrated in the rural network. Solar United Madagascar's Digital Learning Programme grew from two pilot schools in April 2024 to 15 rural public primary schools across four regions, reaching over 2,500 students (September 2025), the scale-up following its two-school pilot. Its classroom model gives teachers individual tablets linked to a Raspberry Pi intranet hub holding offline Ministry of Education textbooks, visual aids and the Rachel and Kiwix open-source libraries, alongside teacher professional-development and certification-exam preparation, powered by the same solar equipment that supplies after-dark study lighting — a design built for schools with neither grid power nor a usable connection. The state's own basic digital-literacy work sits as one strand of the World Bank DECIM project's digital-skills window (November 2025), with no amount attached to it.

Training and skills

Skills, not money or infrastructure, are what holds the sector back on its own account: 87 per cent of those surveyed for Madagascar's Digital Readiness Assessment put a skills deficit ahead of budget and limited ICT infrastructure as the principal obstacle to digital progress (December 2025). The state's answer is a TVET digitalisation strategy adopted in September 2025 carrying a national trainee target.

Delivery is donor cohorts, two opening four days apart: the OIF-backed D-CLIC entered its operational phase on 19 January 2026, offering free digital-skills training toward a target of 1,000 young people by mid-2026, and ASAN'AI opened applications on 23 January 2026 for a free 15-month digital and business-process-outsourcing programme for 1,300 young people across four cohorts. DECIM's US$15m digital-skills window allocates US$0.3m to training 5,700 people in advanced digital skills, US$2.4m to the research and education network iRENALA, and US$3m with SAYNA plus US$7.5m of renovation to turning the distance-learning institution CNTEMAD into a private virtual university (November 2025).

The two cohorts launched in January 2026 come to 2,300 training places between them, under 6 per cent of the national target of 40,000 digital-skills trainees by 2028.

Training inside the administration hits a ceiling one evaluation names plainly: PAPESI trained 115 education ministry agents in planning methods and put agents through the rebuilt SIGE, but its evaluation records notable improvement at individual level against limited effects at organisational and institutional level, with a national strategy drafted to extend the training to remaining staff (March 2025). Specialist streams do better: meteorological staff are trained through the University of Antananarivo and the WMO regional training centres it hosts, ENEAM and ESPA (November 2023), and 85 magistrates and 55 institutional representatives attended the three-day UNESCO seminar that adopted the judiciary's AI ethics charter in June 2026.

A five-year agreement signed on 10 February 2023 by the education ministry, UNICEF and Airtel gave 14,000 students in 15 public lower-secondary schools free access to a digital-learning platform, and Orange's 2025-2026 écoles numériques rollout launched at CEG Nanisana, a school of 2,700 students, with tablets, computers, projectors and teacher training (May 2026).

Research institutions

The national research and education network has a funded line: US$2.4m of the World Bank DECIM project's digital-skills window goes to iRENALA (November 2025). Tertiary provision in computing runs through the École Nationale d'Informatique at Fianarantsoa, which added an artificial intelligence programme in 2023, ISPM with engineering tracks in ICT, AI and cybersecurity, and the dedicated IT institute INSI, and applied research gained a shared facility with UniPod Madagascar, inaugurated on 28 May 2026 at the CIDST site in Tsimbazaza, Antananarivo and sitting inside the higher-education ministry's own Direction de la Recherche et de l'Innovation, delivered with the industry ministry and UNDP's pan-African Timbuktoo initiative.

What is thinner is research on whether public digital and scientific services work. The 2023 hydromet peer review found no research at all on the social and economic benefit of the Direction Générale de la Météorologie's services — precisely the evidence a budget case for the agency would rest on. Where evaluation is being built in, it is a donor doing it: a baseline evaluation of Solar United Madagascar's Digital Learning Programme, run with the education ministry's Evaluation Unit, began in September 2025, with an endline planned for June 2026 measuring reading, writing and numeracy gains.

Inclusion

Access to services

Madagascar's national police opened an online platform for reporting gender-based violence and disappearances in July 2026, alongside the existing local police channels; a report can be filed anonymously and tracked by reference number. More than thirteen thousand survivors of gender-based violence received integrated medical, psychosocial and legal care in 2025.

The position on ordinary public services is among the weakest on the continent: 24.9 out of 100 for Equal Access to Public Services in 2023, 43rd of 54 African states and down 0.8 points over the decade, with Equal Socioeconomic Opportunity at 22.9. The MICS-7 survey found 42% of the population with an improved water source, 37% with reliable electricity, 17% using improved sanitation and 40% still practising open defecation in 2025, and 42% of women aged 20–24 married before 18, a share INSTAT states has risen since 2018.

Documentation is both the strongest basic-access measure and the obstacle. 80% of children were registered at birth in 2025, while about 6 million adults, some 40% of the adult population, hold no birth certificate (2026). The registration drive is built offline first for the hardest to reach, with field teams and fokontany chiefs confirming undocumented identities against a de-duplicated biometric database (July 2026), and the National Assembly has opened a derogatory registration route for adults with no certificate.

The legal frame is old in places and narrow in others. Loi n° 97-044 of 1998 guarantees persons with disabilities equal rights across health, education, employment and social integration, and a 2019–2022 UN joint programme built disability screening and supplementary grants into cash transfers. Refugees have less: Madagascar acceded to the 1951 Refugee Convention in 1967 but to neither the 1967 Protocol nor the 1969 OAU Refugee Convention as at 2025. Décret n° 2015-957 requires a standing consultation body at every decentralised collectivity, a channel into local policy design for civil society and communities.

Digital delivery reaches few — buying anything online remains marginal (December 2025) — and analogue delivery leaks at the last step: warnings from the national weather service do not reliably reach the people they are issued for (November 2023).

Digital divides

Nine applications to the US$24m affordable-devices window of Madagascar's World Bank-financed DECIM programme had been approved and were in contractualisation by November 2025, with only the Orange and Airtel contracts unsigned, a first call for funds of US$2.5m made to the project unit on 7 November 2025 and start-up advances due to disburse at the end of that month. A student laptop pilot, at study stage at the same date, opened in September 2026, when the postal microfinance institution Paositra Finances began selling laptops on 12-month credit to 1,400 master's students at the universities of Antananarivo and Fianarantsoa, made possible by part of the DECIM envelope.

Around four in five Malagasy did not use the internet in 2024, and internet use sits far below mobile-phone penetration of 44.4%, so network reach is not the whole of it. Mobile internet costs several times the UN affordability benchmark, and in December 2025 the state and the operators announced an agreement to bring tariffs down gradually, the state offering excise-duty relief against reinvestment in network quality. The Ibrahim Index records the same split from the other side: internet and computer access has barely moved over the decade while mobile telephony has advanced far faster.

The divide is geographic before it is anything else. Rural electricity access runs far below urban, and the regulator ARTEC published the country's first region-level 4G coverage figures in September 2025, covering the four regions of the deep south and none of the rest.

Where the state digitises, the exclusion follows the same contours. The e-Facturation decree phases electronic invoicing in with large enterprises first and acknowledges that many small and medium firms have neither the computer tools nor a stable connection to comply, promising training rather than exemption. In payments, registered mobile money accounts outnumber active ones several times over. Launching the 2025–2026 school digital-kit deployment in May 2026, the president of Orange Solidarité Madagascar named the gap on the record, framing the equipment as a response to it rather than a pedagogical upgrade.

Data

National statistics

Statistical capacity was Madagascar's fifth most improved of the 96 indicators in the Ibrahim Index, rising 20.1 points over 2014-2023 to 42.9 out of 100 — and still 34th of 54 African states, below the midpoint. The World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators for 2023 put the system in the 70-89% band for data products and the 50-69% band for data use and services, but in the 20-49% band for both data sources and data infrastructure: the administrative and geospatial inputs, and the systems that hold them, are the weak part of the machine.

That shows in what has not been counted. There has been no economic or business census in twenty years, and neither an agricultural nor a business survey in the past ten. The statutory frame is recent: loi n° 2018-004 repealed the 1967 law, established the Système Statistique National and the Conseil National de la Statistique, and set INSTAT's role across 78 articles.

MICS-7, the first multiple indicator cluster survey since 2018, ran fieldwork from late December 2024 to May 2025 across around 20,000 households, reporting in February 2026; INSTAT puts roughly 43% of Madagascar's SDG indicators as informed by that one dataset, and the round measures 43 indicators across 11 SDGs and more than 20 targets, fifteen times the count of the first cycle in 1995. INSTAT also published the Livret Genre in February 2026, the country's first dedicated gender-statistics compendium.

The fourth population and housing census is planned for 2028, its project document presented in May 2026 after an evaluation of the 2018 round, with no budget, implementation timetable or settled strategic orientation attached to it.

Public finance is the acknowledged weak point. An IMF mission in March 2026 welcomed the government-finance-statistics decree and recommended a GFS committee; the Treasury names coverage extending only to entities it tracks itself, sources inconsistent on subsidies, and granularity too thin to build a complete balance sheet.

Every major statistical undertaking on the record between August 2025 and June 2026 — the microdata platform, MICS-7, the census project document and the finance-statistics reform — carried external technical or financial support.

Open data

Madagascar has no enacted access-to-information law, the draft loi n° 017/2025 still unpassed as at 27 August 2026 after attempts running back to 2006. The bill reached committee stage on 8 May 2026, with deputies aiming to adopt it in plenary on 18 May; nothing records that vote, and the bill was then left off the order paper of the extraordinary session opened on 25 August 2026.

The text laid before Parliament by décret n° 2025-1526 of 3 December 2025 runs to 88 articles, making accessibility a principle alongside systematic and spontaneous disclosure and free-of-charge access, with a digital-governance principle at article 4.10 requiring progressive digitalisation of public services.

What is already published scores poorly. Open Data Watch's 2024 inventory finds no assessable open data at all in five categories — digital and ICT economic statistics, energy, pollution, crime, and health facilities — each scoring zero out of ten on coverage and openness. On the Ibrahim Index, disclosure of public records stood at 27.9 out of 100 in 2023, down 0.8 points over the decade, and accessibility of public records at 29.1, up 5.3. Publication is not always retrieval either: two of the PRODIGY safeguard documents released in April 2026 cannot be downloaded at all.

The substantial opening is INSTAT's public microdata platform, financed under the World Bank's STATCAP-II project, which has since August 2025 given researchers and policymakers disaggregated data from the 2018 census, the 2020-2021 COVID-19 impact waves and the 2021-2022 household survey; the finance ministry frames it as transparency and accountability through access to raw data.

Across the 23 categories the 2024 open data inventory scores, Madagascar averages 3.0 out of 10 and no category exceeds 5.0, the best being education outcomes. The census cycle runs at ten years, the third census having been taken in 2018 and the fourth planned for 2028, so the microdata opened in August 2025 will be a decade old before

it is superseded. The economy and finance ministry plans wider publication of budget information after an international assessment scored the country below its threshold, and the Cour des comptes will resume publishing the budget settlement document in 2027.

Use of satellite data

Madagascar's official drought record is a retrospective table of ten major droughts between 1981 and 2020-21, from 14,000 people affected in the smallest event to 1.3 million across six regions in the largest, compiled from disaster-event records rather than from any monitoring product. The same assessment scored both drought monitoring and early warning, and vulnerability and impact assessment, as Low, citing scarce data and limited access to climate information among end users (2023). Since then Cimopolée, a real-time cyclone-tracking platform integrated into the national disaster-risk-management system, has become operational (September 2025).

The satellite work Madagascar is the subject of is largely produced elsewhere. UNDP combined its own satellite imagery of the flooding from cyclones Fytia and Gezani with socioeconomic data to target the recovery response (February 2026), and the first country-wide annual rice-paddy maps, covering 2017 to 2025, were built by external researchers from Landsat and Sentinel-2 imagery. Oversight of the fishing zone follows the same pattern: the EU-Madagascar fisheries partnership agreement commits both parties to the control, monitoring and surveillance of fishing inside Madagascar's waters, a satellite-tracking regime specified in Brussels rather than built at home. Land administration is where domestic use is furthest along, digitising cadastral data from orthophotos without yet arriving at an integrated national land information system.

Madagascar has joined the United Nations Early Warnings for All initiative, and its meteorological service — whose warning services, hydrology and dissemination were judged only basic in a 2023 peer review — signed a memorandum with the China Meteorological Administration in May 2026 covering radar and satellite meteorological capacity-building, cyclone forecasting and multi-hazard early warning.

Satellite communications have moved faster than satellite observation. SpaceX filed with the United States regulator on 13 May 2026 to provide Starlink Direct-to-Cell coverage over Madagascar using Airtel Madagascar's spectrum, and the first trial ran at Sadabe on 11 July 2026, the third in Africa, with commercial launch awaiting authorisation by the regulator ARTEC. Airtel and Eutelsat have also deepened a low-earth-orbit rural broadband partnership on the OneWeb constellation (June 2026).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

No United States government programme, agreement or hyperscaler investment in Madagascar's digital sector had been recorded as at September 2026.

China activities

The Council of Ministers agreed on 4 August 2026 that Madagascar would join an international network against online fraud initiated by China, committing the ministries of foreign affairs, justice, public security and digital development together with the gendarmerie. Six weeks earlier the country had taken part in founding the World AI Cooperation Organization at Shanghai on 16–17 July 2026, and was acceding to it as at August 2026. Two of the arrangements Madagascar has entered for the governance of cybercrime and of artificial intelligence are therefore Chinese-convened, and both were joined in a single summer.

The technical relationship is older and narrower. Madagascar's Direction Générale de la Météorologie and the China Meteorological Administration signed a memorandum of understanding in Shanghai on 18 May 2026 covering early-warning system development, tropical-cyclone forecasting, multi-hazard warning and radar and satellite meteorological capacity-building — the forecasting capability of a cyclone-exposed state, being built with Chinese help.

The one substantial Chinese commitment on the books predates all of it: China Eximbank signed a government concessional loan of some CNY 338 million with Madagascar on 19 February 2020 for a telecommunications network modernisation project, deploying a Huawei 4G eLTE fibre-optic network across public safety and government agencies in Antananarivo together with data management centres, video-conferencing and surveillance cameras, on a 30-year maturity with a five-year grace period at 1.5 percent interest; the Senate approved the agreement on 5 June 2020. A single loan thus placed the state's own communications, its data centres and its camera networks on one vendor's equipment.

Chinese money is nevertheless a small share of what has been committed to Madagascar's digital sector: the Eximbank loan, at about US$55 million, is about a twentieth of the roughly US$1.05 billion on record, against more than nine tenths from the World Bank (September 2026).

EU activities

Madagascar is one of four Eastern and Southern Africa parties — with Comoros, Mauritius and Seychelles — to the enhanced EU-ESA Economic Partnership Agreement, whose negotiations concluded on 10 June 2026 and which the European Commission calls its first modern, comprehensive free-trade agreement with sub-Saharan African partners. It carries a dedicated Digital Trade chapter alongside chapters on customs, technical barriers, rules of origin, agriculture, fisheries and sustainable development, plus a Protocol on Mutual Administrative Assistance in Customs Matters; the digital chapter bars customs duties on electronic transmissions, strengthens online consumer protection and cuts administrative formalities for trade by electronic means.

The customs protocol is where the data commitment actually sits: it carries updated personal-data-protection provisions and an enabling clause for the future automatic exchange of customs information between EU and ESA customs authorities. None of it binds yet — entry into force needs internal EU procedures, Council authorisation to sign, European Parliament consent and ratification by Madagascar, and no signature or ratification date had been stated as at June 2026.

The European Union is the largest trading partner of the four ESA states, taking 24 percent of the group's goods trade and 33 percent of its services trade, with EU-ESA4 trade in goods and services worth €9.7bn in 2024 — €5.2bn of EU imports and €4.5bn of EU exports. The intellectual-property terms will protect 135 EU geographical indications in Madagascar, Mauritius and Seychelles after a transition period.

European financing also runs through much of the digital work already under way: the European Investment Bank's Global Gateway loan to AXIAN Telecom for 4G and 5G rollout, the GIZ-financed African Union Data Governance project inside which the national data policy is being drafted, a Team Europe data-policy training held in Antananarivo in September 2025, the European Commission-funded UNESCO seminar at which Malagasy magistrates adopted an AI ethics charter in June 2026, and Agence française de développement money behind the equipment handed to 29 Greater Antananarivo communes on 3 July 2026. The fisheries partnership agreement in force since December 2023 ties surveillance of who fishes Malagasy waters to a satellite-tracking regime specified in Brussels.

Gulf/UAE activities

President Michael Randrianirina proposed in December 2025 a joint Madagascar–Saudi investment body to coordinate and finance projects including digital governance, and said the country aims to launch a secure national digital platform for public administration and security drawing on Saudi experience; no agreement under it had been recorded as at September 2026. The Emirati contact is exploratory: Abu Dhabi Ports and the Economic Development Board of Madagascar signed a memorandum on 30 May 2024 to explore collaboration that includes the digitisation of logistics services, and no project or amount under it is recorded.

India activities

No Indian government or Indian-financed digital initiative in Madagascar had been recorded as at September 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Madagascar's new biometric identity register runs on a French vendor's database system: the identity database management system was contracted to France's IN Groupe for about €8.5 million in May 2025, with Laxton supplying the enrolment kits, and the system is to sit on state premises, in the primary data centre at Tsimbazaza with a secondary site at Iavoloha. Whether the state holds the source code and operating skills for the identity management system, or can exit its contract with IN Groupe, was not on record as at September 2026.

Beyond that system, state bodies are buying hosting one contract at a time: the social-protection fund FID was tendering the lease of two cloud servers under World Bank financing in September 2026. No instrument fixing where state data is held or under whose law it is processed was in force as at September 2026. The terms on which the Huawei-built government network financed by China Eximbank in 2020 and the IN Groupe identity contract govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

The continental frame is being written in: the first national data policy is to follow a roadmap for domesticating the African Union Data Policy Framework. The government's stated line is cooperation on its own terms: the digital minister told UNESCO's AI-ethics forum in September 2026 that digital sovereignty means international cooperation without excessive dependence, not isolation, and pressed for Malagasy to be built into AI tools.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/MDG/MDG-status-2026-10-12.pdf
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